

Special Points Decoder

Confluent & Coalescent Points — the Extraordinary Vessels

Standalone reference — pairs with the Week 7 Study Guide

This Decoder Covers:

- Confluent (Opening) Points — the special-point category unique to the 8 vessels; all 4 master-couple pairs drilled in full
- Coalescent Points (Jiao Hui Xue) — how 6 of the 8 vessels borrow points from primary meridians
- Why organ-based special-point categories (Yuan-Source, Luo-Connecting, etc.) do NOT apply this week
- Cumulative one-page recap of every special-point category from Weeks 1-6, for continuity

No new organ-based special points this week -- GV/CV/Chong/Dai/Qiao/Wei pertain to no zang-fu organ.
Confluent Points ARE the special-point content for Quiz 6.

Confluent Points (Ba Mai Jiao Hui Xue)

The star category this week

DEFINITION: Confluent points are special acupuncture points -- always located on a primary meridian, one per vessel -- that connect each Extraordinary Vessel to the 12 regular meridians. They are the clinical “opening” points used to access that vessel's function, and they pair up into 4 “master-couple” combinations used together in treatment.

MOA also has a dedicated “Confluent points of the eight extraordinary channels” section at p.45 -- directly on-topic for this week's Decoder but not in the original syllabus range. Not required, but worth asking Dr. Zhang whether it should be.

Chong Mai + Yin Wei Mai

SP 4 Gongsun × PC 6 Neiguan

Stomach, heart, chest -- Gongsun opens Chong, Neiguan opens Yin Wei; combine to treat chest/epigastric/cardiac patterns.

Du Mai + Yang Qiao Mai

SI 3 Houxi × BL 62 Shenmai

Inner canthus, neck, ear, shoulder -- spinal stiffness/pain, febrile disease, mental disorders.

Ren Mai + Yin Qiao Mai

LU 7 Lieque × KI 6 Zhaohai

Lung, throat, chest, diaphragm -- cough, sore throat, chest tightness.

Dai Mai + Yang Wei Mai

GB 41 Zulinqi × SJ 5 Waiguan

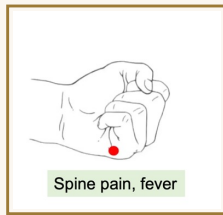
Outer canthus, ear, cheek, neck, shoulder -- lateral-body pain, febrile disease, exterior patterns.

MEMORY AID

All 4 pairs put one point on the ARM and one on the LEG. The arm point is always the vessel's confluent point on a Yin (Lung/Pericardium) or Yang (Small Intestine/San Jiao) hand meridian; the leg point mirrors it on the corresponding foot meridian territory (Kidney/Spleen for the yin pairs, Bladder/Gallbladder for the yang pairs).

Confluent Points — Location Cards

New for this edition -- Dr. Zhang's own review slides



SI 3 Houxi

Du Vessel

LOCATION

On the ulnar side of the hand, proximal to the fifth metacarpophalangeal joint, at the border of the red and white skin.

KEY FUNCTIONS

Benefits the spine and neck; clears heat; treats febrile disease and back pain.



LU 7 Lieque

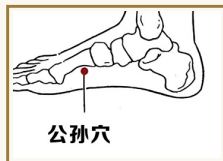
Ren Vessel

LOCATION

On the radial forearm, 1.5 cun proximal to the wrist crease, superior to the styloid process of the radius.

KEY FUNCTIONS

Releases the exterior, benefits the throat and lungs, and regulates the Ren Vessel.



SP 4 Gongsun

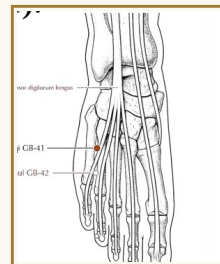
Chong Vessel

LOCATION

On the medial foot, distal and inferior to the base of the first metatarsal bone.

KEY FUNCTIONS

Harmonizes the middle jiao, regulates the Chong Vessel, and treats abdominal or menstrual disorders.



GB 41 Zulinqi

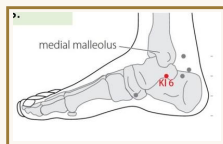
Dai Vessel

LOCATION

On the dorsum of the foot, distal to the junction of the fourth and fifth metatarsal bones.

KEY FUNCTIONS

Spreads Liver qi, regulates the Dai Vessel, benefits the breasts, and treats pelvic or lateral-body pain.



KI 6 Zhaohai

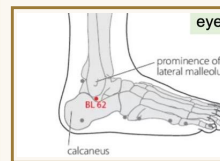
Yin Qiao Vessel

LOCATION

In the depression directly below the medial malleolus.

KEY FUNCTIONS

Nourishes yin, benefits the throat, regulates sleep, in charge of movement.



BL 62 Shenmai

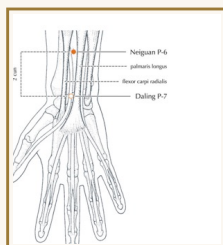
Yang Qiao Vessel

LOCATION

In the depression directly below the lateral malleolus.

KEY FUNCTIONS

Regulates the Yang Qiao Vessel, benefits the eyes, calms the spirit, and motor functions.



PC 6 Neiguan

Yin Wei Vessel

LOCATION

Two cun proximal to the wrist crease, between the tendons of palmaris longus and flexor carpi radialis.

KEY FUNCTIONS

Opens the chest, regulates the Heart, calms the spirit, harmonizes the Stomach, and relieves nausea.



SJ 5 Waiguan

Yang Wei Vessel

LOCATION

Two cun proximal to the dorsal wrist crease, between the radius and ulna.

KEY FUNCTIONS

Releases the exterior, clears heat, benefits the head and ears, and relieves pain along the yang channels.

Coalescent Points (Jiao Hui Xue)

How the vessels without their own points work

DEFINITION: Coalescent points are the meeting points between an Extraordinary Vessel and a primary meridian along the vessel's course. Only GV and CV have their own dedicated points -- the other 6 vessels are described ENTIRELY through the primary-meridian points they cross. Do not confuse a vessel's coalescent points (many, descriptive of its course) with its ONE confluent point (the clinical opening point).

Coalescent Points by Vessel

Governor Vessel (Du Mai) (2 pts)

BL 12 Fengmen · CV 1 Huiyin

Conception Vessel (Ren Mai) (2 pts)

ST 1 Chengqi · GV 28 Yinjiao

Thoroughfare Vessel (Chong Mai) (14 pts)

CV 1 · CV 7 · ST 30 · KI 11 · KI 12 · KI 13 · KI 14 · KI 15 · KI 16 · KI 17 · KI 18 · KI 19 · KI 20 · KI 21

Belt Vessel (Dai Mai) (3 pts)

GB 26 Daimai · GB 27 Wushu · GB 28 Weidao

Yang Heel Vessel (Yang Qiao Mai) (10 pts)

BL 1 · BL 59 · BL 61 · BL 62 · GB 20 · GB 29 · SI 10 · ST 1 · ST 3 · ST 4

• Slide header states "(12)" coalescent points but only 10 are named -- flagged for Dr. Zhang.

Yin Heel Vessel (Yin Qiao Mai) (3 pts)

KI 6 · KI 8 · BL 1

Yang Link Vessel (Yang Wei Mai) (14 pts)

BL 63 · SI 10 · GV 15 · GV 16 · GB 21 · GB 35 · GB 13 · GB 14 · GB 15 · GB 16 · GB 17 · GB 18 · GB 19 · GB 20

• Slide header states "(15)" coalescent points but only 14 are named -- flagged for Dr. Zhang.

Yin Link Vessel (Yin Wei Mai) (7 pts)

KI 9 · SP 13 · SP 15 · SP 16 · LR 14 · CV 22 · CV 23

Cumulative Recap — Categories NOT New This Week

For continuity only

None of the Eight Extraordinary Vessels pertains to a zang or fu organ, and none has an interior-exterior paired relationship the way the 12 primary meridians do. Only Du Mai (GV) and Ren Mai (CV) have their own dedicated acupuncture points -- the other six vessels borrow points from the primary meridians they cross (their “coalescent points,” Jiao Hui Xue).

Because none of the 8 vessels pertains to a zang/fu organ, the organ-based special-point categories drilled in earlier weeks' decoders (Yuan-Source, Luo-Connecting, Xi-Cleft, He-Sea, Lower He-Sea, Front-Mu, Back-Shu, Hui-Meeting, Jing-Well/Ying-Spring/Shu-Stream/Jing-River, Command Points) do not introduce new examples this week. They stay exactly as covered previously -- listed below strictly for cumulative review continuity.

YUAN-SOURCE

Where the Source (Yuan) Qi is accessed.

Last new examples: Week 6 (PC7, SJ4, GB40, LR3)

LUO-CONNECTING

Where a Luo-vessel branches to the paired channel.

Last new examples: Week 6 (PC6, SJ5, GB37, LR5)

HE-SEA

At elbow/knee; treats counterflow Qi and organ-level disorders.

Last new examples: Week 6 (PC3, SJ10, GB34, LR8)

XI-CLEFT

Cleft point for acute conditions/pain.

Last new examples: Week 6 (PC4, SJ7, GB36, LR6)

FRONT-MU

Where a zang/fu organ's Qi gathers anteriorly.

Last new examples: Week 6 (CV17, CV5, GB24, LR14)

BACK-SHU

Bladder-channel transport points for each organ.

Last new examples: Week 6 (BL14, BL22, BL19, BL18)

HUI-MEETING (INFLUENTIAL)

8 points, meeting place for a tissue/substance category.

Last new examples: Week 6 (GB34 = Sinews; LR13 = Zang)

JING-WELL / YING-SPRING / SHU-STREAM / JING-RIVER

The Five-Shu points along each channel.

Last new examples: Week 6

LOWER HE-SEA

Special He-Sea points for the 6 Fu organs, on the leg.

Last new examples: Week 6 (SJ's is BL39, off-channel)

CROSSING POINTS

A point crossed by more than one channel's pathway.

GB count still flagged/unresolved (Week 6)